

Disturbance Mapping Project Checklist

PHASE 1 - Project Setup & Data Package

✓	Task	Notes / Reference
☐	Define Area of Interest (AOI)	Create single-polygon geopackage or shapefile in correct CRS (e.g. EPSG:3578)
☐	Check AOI against dataset boundary	Determines Option 1 or Option 2 workflow (see Figure 1 in manual)
☐	Option 1: Run Geopackage Creator app	Download linear/areal disturbances, grids, and ancillary layers → save as data_package.gpkg
☐	Option 2: Download template files from GitHub	Download data_package.gpkg (empty layers) and digitizing_project2.qgz; create grids via Validation app
☐	Download QGIS project template from GitHub	digitizing_project1.qgz (Option 1) or digitizing_project2.qgz (Option 2)
☐	Create project directory; place files inside	Put .qgz and data_package.gpkg together in the same folder
☐	Open QGIS project & verify all layers load	Confirm: disturbance layers, ancillary layers, grids, satellite imagery web services

PHASE 2 - Imagery & Web Services

✓	Task	Notes / Reference
☐	Set primary imagery source	Yukon: SPOT 150 cm mosaic (Satellites/Yukon_Composite_150cm); other jurisdictions: select equivalent
☐	Add VHR imagery as secondary source	ESRI World Imagery, Google, or Bing - useful to confirm disturbance type
☐	Confirm all required web services display correctly	Add manually if missing; check connection before digitizing begins
☐	Load ancillary layers for interpretation	Watercourses, fire history, quartz/placer claims, silviculture, burned areas

PHASE 3 - Digitizing

✓	Task	Notes / Reference
☐	Set digitizing scale to 1:5,000	Use Scale drop-down at bottom of QGIS window
☐	Enable editing on BP_Line or BP_Poly layer	Toggle Editing -> Add Feature; save edits regularly
☐	Use 2x2 km grid to track progress	Mark grid cells complete (status = 1) as you go; work row by row
☐	Check existing disturbance layers first	Do not re-digitize linear_disturbances / areal_disturbances unless features have changed
☐	Assign TYPE_INDUSTRY & TYPE_DISTURBANCE	See Appendix 1 in manual for full allowable value list
☐	Record imagery metadata per feature	IMAGE_NAME, IMAGE_DATE, IMAGE_RESOLUTION, IMAGE_SENSOR, VHR_ASSIST
☐	Measure & record WIDTH_M for linear features	Use Measure Line tool; average across feature if width varies
☐	Apply topology rules	No overlapping polygons; lines may cross but not duplicate; single-part features only
☐	Flag uncertain features (FLAG = 1 + NOTE)	Flag boundary uncertainty, disturbance type doubt, or features needing ground-truthing

PHASE 4 - Validation & Temporal Dating (if required)

✓	Task	Notes / Reference
☐	Peer review of digitized features	Second team member reviews attributes and spatial accuracy
☐	Remote validation with higher-resolution imagery	Compare digitized outlines against VHR imagery
☐	Field-based validation for flagged features	Ground-truth or drone survey; interview knowledge holders as needed
☐	Assign DIST_YEAR using yearly imagery	Toggle yearly imagery to find first year feature appears; record in DIST_YEAR field
☐	Use alternate dating methods where needed	Google Earth Pro timelapse, government records (YESAB, GeoYukon, BC Catalogue)
☐	Flag undatable features (FLAG = 2 + NOTE)	Use '-YEAR' notation for features older than earliest available imagery
☐	Run Disturbance Validation Shiny app	Attribute validation, review results, correct systematic errors

References:

- GitHub: https://github.com/beaconsproject/disturbance_mapping
- Validation app: https://beaconsproject.shinyapps.io/disturbance_validation/
- Geopackage Creator: https://beaconsproject.shinyapps.io/geopackage_creator/